

Children of Hope Child Development Center

September 2026

Hope Happenings: News from Mrs. Mueller's Office

Happy
Birthday!



STAFF Birthday:
August
Mrs. Gerrish-
12th

It is hard to believe that our first month is already over—and what a smashing success it was! New friendships were formed, learning took place, and fears were conquered. Thank you for your help and patience as we all learned about one another and settled into our new routines. We are so proud of how well everyone has adjusted!

September in the Desert

September can be a tricky month in the desert. We want to spend our full scheduled times outside, but the weather just hasn't been cooperating. We have had to limit outdoor time due to high heat and air quality advisories.

Our mud tables are scheduled to be delivered this month, which will provide a little relief from the heat when we are able to open our water-play area. We are looking forward to having another fun way for our friends to explore and play!

Mariposa Therapy Services

On **September 15th**, our friends from **Mariposa Therapy Services** will be here on campus. They will conduct quick observations to screen for possible speech, physical, or occupational concerns.

If anything is noted during the screening, the information will be shared with families during conferences. We bring Mariposa in because we know that early intervention can be key to addressing small concerns before they become bigger ones. Our goal is always to provide the best support possible for each child.

School Pictures

Lifetouch will be on campus September 16th for school pictures! After pictures are taken, Lifetouch will provide information for families who would like to order photos. Lots of our friends like to come to school dressed to impress on picture day!

And Penguins, don't worry about your chapel shirt since September 16th falls on your chapel day. You can still look picture-perfect!

Family Dinner Night at Chipotle

Our next **Family Dinner Night (FDN)** will be at **Chipotle on September 23rd from 4:00–8:00 PM**. This is always a fun opportunity to see our teachers

“in the wild”—most of the kids think we actually live at school! It is also a great chance to enjoy dinner together while giving a little back to our school.

The funds we raise through Family Dinner Nights help us pay for special experiences, including our petting zoo visit. This year, we would **really** love to have them bring the **mini Highland cow**! So come out, grab some dinner, and help us make that happen!

Help Us Grow Our Owlet Room!

We still have several openings available in our **Owlet Room**, and we would love your help spreading the word! If you refer a friend who enrolls, **you will receive \$100 off your October tuition!**

We would love to continue building our Children of Hope family and sharing this special place with others. Having full classrooms also helps us maintain strong enrollment for the following school year.

So, if you know a family who might be a great fit for Children of Hope, send them our way!

Social-Emotional Conferences

We will finish up the month with our **Social-Emotional Conferences**. At the beginning of the month, you will be asked to complete an **ASQ (Ages and Stages Questionnaire)** and return it to your classroom teacher. These questionnaires, combined with teacher observations, give us valuable insight into each child's development and help us understand how we can best support them here at school.

Conferences are also a wonderful opportunity for us to share some of the amazing things we get to witness every day. Our teachers see so many moments of growth, kindness, independence, friendship, and discovery, and we love being able to share those moments with you!

And then, somehow, the month ends with the beginning of **fall break**. How did that happen so fast?!

We are so excited for all that September has in store and are grateful to have your families as part of the Children of Hope family!

Blessings,

Mrs. Mueller



Church Events:

***September 13th – Children's
Message***

***September 27th- Playing and
Praying with Deacon Connie***



**Chapel starts at 8:30 and
everyone is welcome to attend.**



**Gliders-Monday- 14th
Owlets- Tuesday-15th
Penguins- Wednesday-16th**

**You and your child will meet your
classroom teacher up in the sanctuary.
Chapel generally lasts 15-20 minutes.**



Pick Up at 1:00pm: \$15

Pick Up at 2:00pm: \$20

Will invoice via Brightwheel daily and is payable on next month's tuition.

NO LUNCH BUNCH on September 24th due to staff meeting.



No School- Monday September 7th



School Board meeting- Monday
September 14th @ 6:00 PM



Wednesday, September 16th



Fun Friday

September 18th

Theme: Art

Join us for an additional day of fun from
8:30-12:00 pm (no Lunch Bunch)



Fall Conferences-September 21-23rd

More to come from your classroom
teachers.



Family Dinner Night

Wednesday, September 23rd from 4:00-
8:00PM



Monthly Staff Meeting

Thursday, September 24th @ 12:00pm

This means no lunch bunch on this day
and all friends need to be picked up at
noon.



September 28th- October 12th. Classes
resume October 13th



DV Volleyball Home games (a few of you
asked)

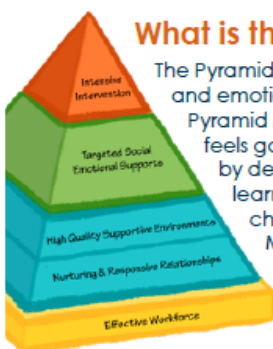
Freshman at 4, JV at 5 and Varsity at 6

August 26th and September 2, 24, 30



Research¹ has shown that the skills your child needs to be successful in the future are social and emotional skills!

The more socially skilled children are, the more likely they are to succeed in school. Because this is so important for your child, we are using the Pyramid Model in our program.



What is the Pyramid Model?

The Pyramid Model is a framework for supporting the social and emotional development of our children. The goal of the Pyramid Model is to create an environment where every child feels good about coming to school. This is accomplished by designing classrooms that promote engagement in learning and by building positive relationships among children, families, and staff. In our use of the Pyramid Model, our classroom staff will work together to ensure that all children understand behavior expectations, receive instruction in social skills, and those who are struggling receive individual support.

The Pyramid Model illustrates that the foundation for helping children develop social and emotional skills is nurturing and responsive relationships and high quality environments. The middle of the Pyramid, teaching of social and emotional skills, is provided to all children with some children receiving additional teaching and support. The top of the Pyramid shows that a few children will need the foundation, the middle AND individualized intervention to address challenging behavior.

To use the Pyramid Model, our program established a leadership team that will provide ongoing support to our staff and families. Our leadership team looks forward to sharing some of the important work we are doing, including teaching program-wide expectations, partnering with families, training staff in teaching strategies, providing classroom coaching to help teachers implement, and using data for decision-making. Stay tuned for ongoing updates about the Pyramid Model in our program!

1 Jones, D. E., Greenberg, M., & Crowley, M. (2015). Early social-emotional functioning and public health: The relationship between kindergarten social competence and future wellness. *American Journal of Public Health*, 105, 2283-2290.

What is gained by using the Pyramid Model?

FAMILIES

- Receive information on how to help promote children's social and emotional skills
- Team with teachers to help children grow and learn
- Receive support for preventing and addressing behavior problems

TEACHERS

- Are effective in helping children learn social and emotional skills
- Strengthen classroom management skills
- Have information and resources to support families

CHILDREN

- Increase their social and emotional skills
- Improve in their readiness for kindergarten

ABC's for parents of little ones...



AWARENESS

Be aware of your own inner state. Is your heart rate elevated? Are you feeling tense/frustrated, etc.? Children can FEEL our upset, so the next step is BREATHE DEEPLY and bring yourself back to the present moment.



BREATHE

Take deep belly breaths. Inhale through your nose for at least 5 seconds, and exhale through your mouth for at least 10 seconds. Do this at least 3 times.



CLOSENESS

They want to be close to you because you are their Safe Place™. Co-regulation and connection/bonding happen when they are close to you. Take deep breaths with them in moments of closeness.

800.842.2846

ConsciousDiscipline.com

© 2020 Loving Guidance, LLC. All rights reserved.

2

ABC's for Parents of Little Ones

As parents, we want to support our little ones during tough times. However, adults can't help children navigate upset and reach a calm state unless we are composed ourselves. This printable resource provides a three-step process for calming yourself and providing the safety your children need.

The inner state of adults (upset or calm) dictates the inner state of young children. A young child cannot feel calm when their parent or caregiver is clearly upset. Children easily pick up on the feelings of the adults around them. If you want to help your child feel composed, the first step is attending to your own composure.

This free resource introduces three steps to help you regain your composure before attempting to calm a child. Print this quick guide for parents of little ones, then post it somewhere prominent as a helpful reminder. With these tips, you'll be a more present and effective guide through these unique times.

Conscious Discipline Glossary:

- **S.T.A.R.:** One of Conscious Discipline's four core breathing techniques, S.T.A.R. stands for **S**mile, **T**ake a deep breath, **A**nd **R**elax. Breathe in through the nose with the belly going out, then out through the mouth with the belly going in. Exhale longer than you inhale. Three deep belly breaths shut off the body's "fight or flight" response.
- **Connection:** The four components of meaningful connection are eye contact, touch, presence and a playful situation.
- **Safe Place™:** The Conscious Discipline Safe Place is a self-regulation center where children use research-based, developmentally appropriate tools and strategies to change their inner state from upset to calm. Only in a calm, optimal state can the brain function well enough to learn and problem-solve effectively. For children, the parent or caregiver is the very first Safe Place.



Please make drop off and pick up times with your child

NO CELL PHONE ZONES 😊

SMOKE-FREE ENVIRONMENT

We at **Children of Hope Child Development Center** are committed to providing a smoke-free environment for children, staff members, and childcare providers. Due to hazards from exposure to second-hand smoke and as a recognized Empower childcare facility, it shall be the policy of this childcare facility to provide a tobacco-free environment for children, staff members, childcare providers, and parents.

